

Acme Corp — QBR prep (internal notes)

Draft scratchpad before the Apr QBR. Don't share externally.

Account background

- Acme Corp — mid-market SaaS, ~800 FTE. Customer since Oct 2024 (~18 months in).
- We ingest their operational data and power their internal analytics layer. Core use case: product analytics + finance reporting.
- Contract: **\$1.2M ARR**. Renewal in ~90 days. Auto-renew clause in the MSA — we do NOT want them to invoke it; want a real conversation.

Stakeholder map

- **Sarah Chen** — VP Data. Our champion, main day-to-day contact. Has political capital but spends it carefully.
- **Marcus Webb** — CTO. Quiet supporter. Rarely pushes back but doesn't evangelize us either. Was on one of the P1 tickets last month (see p.2).
- **Elena Rodriguez** — CFO. **Has joined the last 2 calls UNPROMPTED**. Unusual — CFOs don't show up to vendor reviews unless something's brewing. Flag.
- **Dev Patel** — Head of Data Science. Newer (joined summer 2025). Stance unclear. Haven't had a 1:1 yet.

Offhand / parked items

- Elena asked about 'multi-year pricing flexibility' on the last call — didn't follow up. Probably should have.
- Sarah's calendar invite title changed from just 'QBR' to 'QBR + roadmap'. The 'roadmap' addition is new. Not sure who's driving that — her? Elena? Marcus?

Recent activity — last 90 days

Usage metrics (good news)

- Queries: **+38% QoQ**. Real growth, not a backfill spike.
- Monthly active users: **+12% QoQ**.
- 12 new dashboards deployed to prod (their count, not ours).

Usage metrics (the wrinkle)

- Acme's data science team had layoffs in Feb. Heard it offhand in a Slack thread — 'heard Dev lost 3 of his 8 people'. We've never officially been told. Means the +12% MAU growth is happening even as headcount shrank — or it's being inflated by a few heavy users.
- Training session for their new analysts: **3 of 12 registered**. Low engagement. Sarah didn't comment on the low number when I sent her the list.

Support and reliability (awkward)

- 2 P1 tickets last month. Both resolved, but avg time-to-resolution was **~48h**. Our SLA is 24h. We breached it.
- **Marcus was on one of the P1s**. He didn't escalate publicly but he saw the slow response first-hand. That's the kind of thing a CTO remembers at renewal.
- Our deck says 'avg ticket resolution 18h' — that's the all-tickets average. For P1s specifically it was 48h. Know the difference before they ask.

Open integration request

- Custom data export format — they asked in Q2 2025. We scoped it. Never quoted. Sarah reminded us on the March call. We said 'next quarter' again. Third time.

Competitive intel and open threads

Competitive

- Sarah DM'd me 2 weeks ago: 'someone reached out from [Competitor X]'. She played it cool. I played it cool. Neither of us followed up. Assume they're in at least an exploratory conversation.

Pricing pressure signals

- Elena asked for a 'usage-based pricing options' comparison. I sent a one-pager, no follow-up from her. Our current deal is flat-rate annual.
- **Procurement is now CC'd on all emails.** This is new — they weren't involved in Q4. That's a renewal signal, not a value-review signal.

Open questions we haven't answered

- Q4 ask: custom data export format. Scoped, never quoted. See p.2.
- SOC 2 Type II — Sarah mentioned in Feb that their new healthcare client might require it. Never confirmed with her whether it's still a live requirement.

Our open asks

- Want to expand into their EMEA business unit. Raised in Q4, no traction since. Putting it in the deck for Tuesday anyway (slide 7).

Things to clarify on the day

- Who added 'roadmap' to the QBR invite title and why? If it's Marcus, that's a tech conversation. If it's Elena, it's a pricing conversation in disguise.
- Marcus has never been shown our 2026 roadmap slide. The AM (me) put it in deck without CTO alignment. Risk: he sees something he disagrees with in real time.